

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7) — Paper 5

Chapter 16: Turning Tides: 11th and 12th Centuries

Paper 5 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	16 — Turning Tides: 11th and 12th Centuries
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct.

Apex traps: equating the wealth Mahmud carried home with territorial rule (loot does not equal government); inferring 'all India fell' from the fall of north-western frontiers when the Cholas, Kakatiyas and Hoysalas thrived; collapsing 'raider' and 'conqueror', or Mahmud and the Ghurids, into one category; reversing Tarain (Ghuri LOST 1191, WON 1192) and so misreading which battle was the true hinge; treating learning as one-directional when al-Biruni studied India AND Indian sine tables travelled out; reading the age as 'only war' against al-Biruni, Bhaskaracharya, Ramanuja, Basava, Khajuraho, Brihadishvara and Angkor Wat's Indian echo; and mislabelling terms (vimana=shrine tower, torana=gateway, vachana=Kannada poem, al-jabr='reunion of broken parts', Mount Meru=cosmic mountain, Anubhava mandapa=hall of ideas). Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. A class is given two unlabelled maps. On the first, an invading force barely crosses the lower Indus and halts; on the second, an invading force threads a mountain corridor and reaches deep into the northern plain, later leaving a government behind. Using the chapter's framework, the soundest single inference is that:

- (A) the first map depicts the Turkic wave, since only the Turks were confined near the Indus
- (B) the second map depicts the 11th-12th-century Turkic wave, whose deep penetration and eventual lasting rule are why historians call the period the real turning point
- (C) both maps show the same Arab raids, merely drawn at different scales
- (D) the second map depicts a Gupta reconquest restoring empire across the north

2. A student proposes a rule: 'Any invasion of India is automatically a turning point.' The chapter's handling of the Arab and Turkic waves shows this rule is flawed because it overlooks that:

- (A) what marks a turning point is the depth of penetration and the lasting rule that followed, not the mere fact that an invasion happened
- (B) no invasion of any kind reached India in either wave
- (C) the Arab wave penetrated deeper than the Turkic wave
- (D) both waves left identical lasting governments behind

3. To distinguish 'resilience' from mere 'survival,' a teacher asks which observation would NOT count as resilience. The best answer is:

- (A) that scholars kept writing major new works while the north faced invasions
- (B) that every kingdom was destroyed and then rebuilt as an exact copy of itself once the invasions ended
- (C) that thinker-saints founded new movements during the same decades as the raids
- (D) that temple-builders raised monumental new shrines amid the upheaval

4. A debater argues that because invaders kept using the north-western passes, India simply lacked any sea defences. The chapter's reasoning instead implies that:

- (A) India had no coastline at all during this period
- (B) the southern Cholas had no ships and so could not defend any coast
- (C) the passes were Chola naval bases that deliberately admitted invaders
- (D) the passes were long-established overland routes, so the north-west was a recurring land gateway for trade and invasion, a point about geography rather than about absent sea defences

5. The Hindu Shahis are placed in the EARLY phase of the Turkic invasions. The most precise reason the chapter gives them this role is that they:

- (A) ruled the Tamil south and raised the Brihadishvara temple against the invaders
- (B) founded the Delhi Sultanate once the Battles of Tarain were over
- (C) tried to guard the north-western approaches against the first wave of Turkic invaders, before lasting foreign rule took hold
- (D) sailed across the sea to Srivijaya to resist the invaders by naval power

6. Suppose the north-western passes had been impassable cliffs with no route through. Applying the chapter's own logic, the most defensible consequence is that:

- (A) Mahmud of Ghazni would instead have stayed to rule all of India
- (B) the Cholas would have lost their southern navy as a result
- (C) al-Biruni would have been unable to learn Sanskrit
- (D) the overland Turkic invaders would have found it far harder to enter India repeatedly, weakening the chain that led toward lasting rule

7. A pupil claims, 'Mahmud carried away immense treasure, so he must have ruled the lands he raided.' The flaw the chapter would identify is that:

- (A) Mahmud never actually entered India, so he could have taken nothing
- (B) treasure can only be gathered by a ruler who governs the land for years
- (C) plunder is wealth seized in a raid after which the raider withdraws, so amassing treasure does not require holding or governing any territory
- (D) Mahmud's treasure proves he founded the Delhi Sultanate to manage it

8. A timeline card reads: 'Brihadishvara temple destroyed by Mahmud during his raids.' The single best correction is that:

- (A) Mahmud destroyed Angkor Wat, which is simply another name for Brihadishvara
- (B) Brihadishvara is the same building as Nalanda, which Mahmud razed
- (C) Mahmud's famous raid targeted Somnath, while Brihadishvara was a Chola temple of Rajaraja I in the far south, beyond his reach
- (D) the card is accurate, since Mahmud's raids reached the southern Chola country

9. Two students define a key term. One says a conqueror 'takes treasure and immediately leaves'; the other says a raider 'stays to govern the land he takes.' The chapter shows that:

- (A) both definitions are swapped: a raider takes treasure and leaves, while a conqueror stays to govern the land
- (B) both definitions are exactly correct as stated
- (C) only the first is correct, since a conqueror does leave at once
- (D) the two terms mean precisely the same thing, so neither definition matters

10. A debater insists, 'Mahmud and the Ghurids were the same kind of force because both used violence.' The single fact that most cleanly refutes this is that:

- (A) Mahmud reached India while the Ghurids never crossed the passes
- (B) the Ghurids raided only once and left, while Mahmud governed for centuries
- (C) the Ghurids were a southern dynasty that had absorbed the Cholas
- (D) after each victory the Ghurids stayed on to govern, whereas Mahmud withdrew with his loot after every raid

11. Why does the chapter credit the Ghurids, and not Mahmud, with beginning lasting foreign rule in north India, even though Mahmud invaded far more often?

- (A) because Mahmud reached India only once while the Ghurids invaded seventeen times
- (B) because lasting rule comes from staying to govern after victory, which the Ghurids did and Mahmud, despite his many raids, never did
- (C) because the Ghurids invaded before Mahmud and so had the first claim
- (D) because Mahmud's raids were peaceful trade missions and so could not found rule

12. Place in correct earliest-to-latest order: (i) Aibak founds the Delhi Sultanate; (ii) Mahmud of Ghazni's plundering raids; (iii) the Ghurids establish lasting rule in the north.

- (A) the Ghurids' lasting rule, then Mahmud's raids, then Aibak's Sultanate
- (B) Mahmud's raids, then the Ghurids' lasting rule, then Aibak's Delhi Sultanate
- (C) Aibak's Sultanate, then the Ghurids' rule, then Mahmud's raids
- (D) Mahmud's raids, then Aibak's Sultanate, then the Ghurids' rule

13. A claim runs: 'Mahmud's raids and the Ghurid conquest both used force, so they had the same long-term result.' The best correction is that:

- (A) both equally produced a lasting north-Indian sultanate
- (B) neither produced any lasting result, since both forces left at once
- (C) only the Ghurid conquest produced lasting rule and a sultanate, while Mahmud's raids left no government behind
- (D) Mahmud's raids produced the sultanate while the Ghurids merely looted and left

14. A student lists Mahmud of Ghazni among the founders of the Delhi Sultanate. The single best reason this is an error is that:

- (A) Mahmud never reached India and so could found nothing there
- (B) the Delhi Sultanate was in fact founded by the Hindu Shahis
- (C) the Sultanate was founded by Aibak, a Ghurid general, generations after Mahmud's loot-and-leave raids
- (D) the Delhi Sultanate was a southern kingdom built by the Cholas

15. A pupil writes that the Second Battle of Tarain (1192) was Prithviraj Chauhan's revenge victory after losing the First (1191). Correcting only what is wrong, the right statement is:

- (A) the wins are reversed: Prithviraj won the First (1191), but lost the Second (1192) to Muhammad Ghuri, which opened the way to lasting rule
- (B) the dates are reversed: the Second came in 1191 and the First in 1192
- (C) Prithviraj indeed lost the First then won the Second, exactly as the pupil says
- (D) both battles were Ghurid victories, so Prithviraj never won at Tarain

16. Why is the Second Battle of Tarain, rather than the First, treated as the true hinge of the period?

- (A) because the First ended the Ghurid threat permanently, leaving nothing to hinge on
- (B) because the First was fought at sea and so could decide nothing on land
- (C) because the Second restored the Hindu Shahis to power in the north-west
- (D) because Ghuri's victory in the Second opened the way to lasting foreign rule, soon formalised as the Delhi Sultanate, while the First had merely checked him

17. A history quiz asks which mistake would follow from reversing the two Battles of Tarain in memory. The best answer is that one would wrongly conclude:

- (A) that Mahmud of Ghazni personally commanded both battles at Tarain
- (B) that the Cholas decided the outcome of both engagements

(C) that the battles took place before the Arabs ever reached Sindh

(D) that Prithviraj's resistance failed first and then succeeded, hiding the real sequence by which Ghurid rule actually took hold

18. Aibak and Bakhtiyar Khilji are paired in the chapter to show 'two faces' of the conquest. The pairing best illustrates that the conquest:

(A) left both governance and learning entirely unchanged

(B) only raided for treasure and never governed anything at all

(C) served the Cholas and helped expand their southern navy

(D) built new political rule, the Sultanate, while also destroying old centres of learning, the great universities

19. A student attributes the destruction of Nalanda and Vikramashila to Mahmud of Ghazni. The correct fix is that this destruction was the work of:

(A) Rajaraja Chola I, who also built the Brihadishvara temple

(B) al-Biruni, the scholar who had studied India

(C) Bakhtiyar Khilji, a general of the later Ghurid conquest, not Mahmud of Ghazni

(D) the Hindu Shahis, who guarded the north-western passes

20. Why does the chapter treat the loss of Nalanda and Vikramashila as a blow to knowledge itself, more than the loss of an ordinary town?

(A) because they were Chola naval bases vital to control of the southern coast

(B) because they were Turkic frontier forts guarding the north-western passes

(C) because they were Tamil trading ports central to overseas commerce

(D) because they were great Buddhist universities, so destroying them struck directly at centres of learning and scholarship

21. A debater says al-Biruni 'came with the armies, so his book was just propaganda for the invaders.' The strongest counter the chapter offers is that he:

(A) never actually wrote anything about India at all

(B) learned Sanskrit and wrote a careful, serious study of India's sciences, religion and customs

(C) refused to study any Indian subject whatever

(D) personally led the destruction of Nalanda and Vikramashila

22. Which single pair of facts best demonstrates that the period's learning ran 'two ways' rather than one?

(A) al-Biruni destroyed Indian books, while Indians copied foreign ones

(B) India learned everything from foreign scholars and gave nothing back

(C) al-Biruni studied India's sciences, while Indian sine tables travelled outward to influence mathematics elsewhere

(D) no exchange of knowledge took place in either direction at all

23. A student concludes from Indian sine tables shaping mathematics abroad that 'India only borrowed knowledge and never gave any.' The chapter shows the opposite, namely that India was:

- (A) a place wholly without any mathematics of its own
- (B) a giver as well as a receiver of knowledge in this period
- (C) always borrowing ideas and never once contributing them
- (D) a land whose knowledge never crossed its own borders

24. A worksheet states: 'al-jabr means the cosmic mountain, and a vimana means algebra.' Correcting both errors, the right statement is:

- (A) al-jabr is a temple tower, while a vimana means algebra
- (B) al-jabr means 'reunion of broken parts' and gives the word algebra, while a vimana is the tower over a South Indian temple's main shrine
- (C) both al-jabr and vimana refer to the cosmic mountain
- (D) al-jabr is a Kannada poem, while a vimana is a fleet of warships

25. Trigonometry mattered to the astronomers of this age above all because it is the mathematics of:

- (A) decorative temple gateways and their carved figures
- (B) fighting ships and the sailors who crew them
- (C) triangles and angles, which astronomers used to measure positions in the sky
- (D) short Kannada poems composed by the thinker-saints

26. That an Arabic-named subject, algebra from al-jabr, sits in the chapter beside an Indian export, the sine tables, best supports the conclusion that mathematics in this age was:

- (A) invented solely in India with no outside contact whatever
- (B) an international enterprise, with ideas and names crossing between cultures
- (C) developed only by Turkic generals while on military campaign
- (D) abandoned everywhere until the invasions had finally ended

27. A teacher pairs al-Biruni's careful study of India with Bhaskaracharya's mathematics. Taken together, the single misconception this pairing most directly refutes is that:

- (A) India had ever possessed any mathematics at all
- (B) the invasions had brought serious scholarship in and about India to an end
- (C) the southern kingdoms had managed to stay free of the invaders
- (D) the Cholas had built a powerful navy in the south

28. Bhaskaracharya's career flourishing in this period is best used as evidence for which broad claim?

- (A) Indian science was entirely a foreign invention
- (B) Indian mathematics vanished until the Cholas later revived it

- (C) science was practised only in the regions Mahmud had raided
- (D) Indian science endured and kept advancing despite the northern invasions

29. The Kakatiyas of the Deccan are linked to the torana at Warangal. Among these, the option that correctly identifies a torana is:

- (A) the tall tower raised over a temple's main shrine
- (B) a village assembly that managed local affairs
- (C) a decorative stone gateway, a piece of monumental art
- (D) a subordinate ruler who owed loyalty to a greater king

30. Grouping the Cholas, Kakatiyas and Hoysalas, the single feature the chapter says all three share is that they were:

- (A) Turkic dynasties that entered India through the north-western passes
- (B) founders of the Delhi Sultanate after the Battles of Tarain
- (C) southern or Deccan Indian powers that flourished while the north faced invasions
- (D) Central Asian raiders allied with Mahmud of Ghazni

31. A caption pairs the Kakatiyas' torana at Warangal with the Hoysalas flourishing in the Deccan. The conclusion this pairing best supports is that:

- (A) while the north faced invasions, the south remained free and went on creating great works
- (B) the whole of India had fallen to the Turkic invaders
- (C) the Deccan was governed directly from Ghazni
- (D) the south had no kingdoms of its own in this period

32. The Paramaras are tied to a ruler the chapter calls a 'scholar-king.' Calling Bhoja a scholar-king rather than merely a king stresses that he:

- (A) never held any throne or governed any land
- (B) was a foreign invader rather than an Indian ruler
- (C) commanded the Chola navy instead of leading an army
- (D) actively championed learning alongside the work of ruling

33. Rajaraja Chola I and Rajendra Chola I are remembered together chiefly because both:

- (A) strengthened Chola power, including its navy, and extended the dynasty's reach
- (B) raided Somnath and withdrew with the plunder
- (C) were defeated at the Battles of Tarain
- (D) founded Buddhist universities like Nalanda

34. Rajendra Chola I's naval expedition to Srivijaya matters in this chapter mainly because, set against the raided north, it shows the south to be:

- (A) a far-reaching sea power projecting strength across the Indian Ocean
- (B) a landlocked region dependent on the northern passes

- (C) a vassal forced to serve the Ghurid generals
- (D) a region unaware of any lands beyond its own coast

35. The Cholas' command of the sea, set beside Mahmud's overland raids, best illustrates that India's power in this period was:

- (A) split between flourishing maritime southern kingdoms and a north repeatedly raided by overland invaders
- (B) concentrated entirely in Ghazni in the north-west
- (C) wholly maritime, with no land kingdoms anywhere
- (D) limited to the Hindu Shahis of the north-western frontier

36. Which statement correctly separates a 'navy' from a 'vimana'?

- (A) a navy is a temple tower, while a vimana is a fleet of ships
- (B) a navy is a country's fighting ships and crews, while a vimana is the tower over a temple's main shrine
- (C) both terms mean the same decorative gateway
- (D) a navy is a Kannada poem, while a vimana is a village assembly

37. The Brihadishvara temple's soaring vimana, raised under Rajaraja Chola I, is best read as evidence that:

- (A) monumental temple architecture flourished in the free south during this period
- (B) the Cholas built temples only after the Delhi Sultanate had fallen
- (C) Mahmud of Ghazni had sponsored the Cholas' temple-building
- (D) the south had given up temple construction by this age

38. Ramanujacharya's philosophy, Vishishtadvaita, is best summarised as the teaching that:

- (A) the world and individual souls are real, with bhakti and surrender to God as the path to liberation
- (B) the world is wholly unreal and must be denied
- (C) ritual sacrifice by itself sets the soul free
- (D) there are no gods of any kind

39. Basavanna's Lingayat movement rejected caste and ritual. The institution he set up to embody that openness was the:

- (A) Delhi Sultanate, the seat of a sultan's rule
- (B) torana, a decorative ceremonial gateway
- (C) Anubhava mandapa, a hall where people of all backgrounds met to exchange ideas
- (D) Chola navy, a fleet open to recruits of every kind

40. A 'vachana,' the form Basavanna used to spread his message, is:

- (A) a short Kannada poem expressing spiritual and ethical ideas
- (B) the towering shrine of a South Indian temple
- (C) a fleet of fighting ships
- (D) a decorative stone gateway

- 41.** That the Lingayats welcomed all to the Anubhava mandapa while rejecting caste shows the movement valued, above all:
- (A) a strict caste hierarchy in worship
 - (B) equality and the open exchange of ideas across social backgrounds
 - (C) the supremacy of a single sultan over all
 - (D) the military conquest of the south
- 42.** Ramanuja's bhakti teaching and Basava's Lingayat movement are placed together in the chapter mainly to show that this age:
- (A) produced no religious thought of any kind
 - (B) produced influential new religious thinkers and devotional movements even amid the invasions
 - (C) was occupied only by war and destruction
 - (D) saw all spiritual life replaced by foreign rule
- 43.** Khajuraho and Brihadishvara are cited side by side to argue that, in this period, India was:
- (A) wholly given over to warfare with no building at all
 - (B) ruled in every region from Ghazni
 - (C) stripped of all artistic activity
 - (D) rich in temple art and architecture across different regions
- 44.** Angkor Wat in Cambodia appears in a chapter on India because its five towers symbolise Mount Meru. This best shows that:
- (A) India had conquered and ruled Cambodia by force
 - (B) Cambodia had invaded and ruled India
 - (C) Indian cultural and religious ideas spread peacefully far beyond India's borders
 - (D) India possessed no temples of its own in this age
- 45.** The five towers of Angkor Wat are said to represent Mount Meru, which is:
- (A) a fortress built by Mahmud of Ghazni
 - (B) the largest of the Chola warships
 - (C) a Buddhist university like Nalanda
 - (D) the cosmic mountain at the centre of the universe in Indian cosmology
- 46.** The grand temples within India together with India's influence on Angkor Wat best support the conclusion that the period's India was:
- (A) artistically barren and culturally isolated
 - (B) a thriving cultural centre whose art and ideas radiated well beyond its borders
 - (C) entirely ruled by the invaders in every region
 - (D) a place where temple-building had been forbidden
- 47.** Which statement correctly distinguishes a 'vimana' from a 'torana'?
- (A) a vimana is a gateway, while a torana is the shrine tower
 - (B) both are types of warship

(C) a vimana is the tower over a temple's main shrine, while a torana is a decorative gateway

(D) a vimana is a Kannada poem, while a torana is a sultan's realm

48. In a list of southern and Deccan powers that stayed free in this period, which name is the ODD ONE OUT?

(A) the Cholas

(B) the Kakatiyas

(C) the Hoysalas

(D) the Ghurids

49. Which combination correctly pairs each figure with his defining action?

(A) Mahmud raided for plunder; Muhammad Ghuri came to stay and rule; Aibak founded the Delhi Sultanate

(B) Mahmud founded the Sultanate; Ghuri only raided; Aibak sailed to Srivijaya

(C) Mahmud ruled the south; Ghuri built Angkor Wat; Aibak wrote on algebra

(D) Mahmud led the Chola navy; Ghuri destroyed Nalanda; Aibak defended the Khyber Pass

50. A friend insists, 'The 11th-12th centuries were nothing but invasion and ruin.' The strongest single rebuttal draws on:

(A) the fact that no invasions actually occurred in the period

(B) the claim that the south too was conquered and ruined

(C) the idea that all learning ceased until the 13th century

(D) the scholars al-Biruni and Bhaskaracharya, the thinker-saints Ramanuja and Basava, and the temples of Khajuraho, Brihadishvara and Angkor Wat's Indian echo, all of the same age

51. Taking the chapter as a whole, the statement that best captures the meaning of its title, 'Turning Tides,' is that this period:

(A) saw invasions shift from passing raids to lasting rule in the north, even as the free south and a flowering culture carried India forward

(B) saw the whole subcontinent fall under one foreign throne while culture died out

(C) saw no real change at all from the centuries before it

(D) saw India conquer and rule the lands to its north-west and across the sea

52. A student builds a single causal chain to explain how lasting foreign rule began in north India. Which ordering of links is sound by the chapter's account?

(A) Mahmud's raids founded the Sultanate, after which the Ghurids won at Tarain and opened the passes

(B) the Cholas' Srivijaya expedition let the Ghurids enter, who then lost at the Second Tarain and ruled anyway

(C) usable north-western passes enabled repeated Turkic entry, the Ghurids won at the Second Tarain (1192), and Aibak then founded the Delhi Sultanate

(D) al-Biruni's study guided the Ghurids through the passes to a victory at the First Tarain that founded the Sultanate

53. Two captions read: 'al-Biruni records Indian astronomy' and 'Bakhtiyar Khilji destroys Vikramashila.' Read together, the pair most precisely shows that, in this same age, foreign contact with India:

(A) was uniformly destructive, since both men attacked Indian learning

(B) could both preserve Indian knowledge in writing and destroy Indian centres of learning, depending on whether the figure was a scholar or a conquering general

(C) was uniformly preserving, since both men recorded Indian knowledge

(D) had no effect on Indian learning in either direction

54. A pupil reasons: 'Because the Cholas thrived at sea while the north was raided, the invasions clearly never touched any part of India.' The precise flaw is that:

(A) the Cholas were in fact raided, so the south did not stay free either

(B) the north was never raided, making the pupil's conclusion fully correct

(C) the invasions touched only the south, leaving the north entirely free

(D) the southern flourishing proves much of India stayed free, but the north genuinely was raided, so 'never touched any part' overstates the case

55. A quiz asks for the deeper reason the chapter keeps insisting that 'raiding for loot' and 'conquering to govern' are different ideas, even when both involve armies entering India. The best answer is that the distinction:

(A) is what separates Mahmud, who left after each raid, from the Ghurids, who stayed to rule, and so explains when lasting foreign rule actually began

(B) matters only for vocabulary practice and changes nothing about the history

(C) shows that Mahmud, by raiding most often, must therefore have governed longest

(D) proves that conquest always leaves less behind than a raid does

56. A museum groups four objects under 'monumental art and ideas of the free or culturally radiating India.' Which item does NOT belong with the other three?

(A) the soaring vimana of the Brihadishvara temple

(B) the decorative torana built by the Kakatiyas at Warangal

(C) the five Mount-Meru towers of Angkor Wat reflecting Indian ideas

(D) the loot Mahmud of Ghazni carried home to Ghazni from his raids

57. A student claims al-Biruni's serious study and the Cholas' Srivijaya voyage prove the same single point. The most accurate response is that:

(A) they prove different points: al-Biruni's study shows scholarship continued through the invasions, while the Srivijaya voyage shows the free south's naval reach

(B) they prove the same point, namely that the south was conquered by foreigners

(C) they prove the same point, namely that all learning had stopped

(D) they prove the same point, namely that India ruled both Cambodia and Srivijaya

58. A pupil writes three claims: 'Mahmud ruled all India,' 'the whole subcontinent fell,' and 'nothing of value was created.' How many are correct, and what is the best single correction?

(A) all three are correct exactly as written

(B) only the first is wrong; the other two are correct

(C) none are correct: Mahmud only raided and withdrew, much of India stayed free, and the age produced great scholars, saints and temples

(D) only the third is wrong; Mahmud did rule all of India

59. A debate motion runs: 'al-Biruni's book and the Indian sine tables are simply two examples of the same one-way borrowing.' The sharpest objection, using the chapter, is that:

(A) they run in opposite directions, since al-Biruni's book brought Indian knowledge to foreign readers while the sine tables carried Indian knowledge outward, so together they are two-way, not one-way

(B) they do run one way, since both show India only receiving foreign ideas

(C) they do run one way, since both show foreigners only taking from India and giving nothing

(D) they are unrelated to learning, since both concern military campaigns rather than knowledge

60. A teacher asks why the chapter discusses the Cholas' navy, the Kakatiyas' torana and Basava's Anubhava mandapa in the very same breath as the Turkic raids. The best account of this choice is that the chapter wants to show that:

(A) these southern achievements were all created by the Turkic invaders to govern India

(B) alongside the northern invasions, India was at the same time building sea power, monumental art and movements of open debate, so the age was far more than war

(C) these achievements happened only after the invasions had completely ended

(D) the navy, torana and mandapa were all destroyed in the raids, proving only ruin

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 16: Turning Tides: 11th and 12th Centuries — Paper 5

Paper 5 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	B	11	B	21	B	31	A	41	B	51	A
2	A	12	B	22	C	32	D	42	B	52	C
3	B	13	C	23	B	33	A	43	D	53	B
4	D	14	C	24	B	34	A	44	C	54	D
5	C	15	A	25	C	35	A	45	D	55	A
6	D	16	D	26	B	36	B	46	B	56	D
7	C	17	D	27	B	37	A	47	C	57	A
8	C	18	D	28	D	38	A	48	D	58	C
9	A	19	C	29	C	39	C	49	A	59	A
10	D	20	D	30	C	40	A	50	D	60	B

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (B) The chapter contrasts the early Arab arrival, which stayed near Sindh on the lower Indus, with the later Turkic invasions that drove far into the north through the passes and ultimately produced lasting foreign rule; the second map fits the Turks exactly. The option naming the first map as Turkic reverses the two waves, since it was the Arabs, not the Turks, who were confined near the Indus. Treating both maps as the same Arab raids ignores that one force halts near Sindh while the other reaches deep and leaves a government, a difference the chapter treats as decisive. Calling the deep penetration a Gupta reconquest imports an empire the chapter does not place in this period at all.

2. (A) The chapter distinguishes the two waves precisely on depth and consequence: the Arabs stayed shallow near Sindh and left no lasting Indian government, while the Turks went deep and ultimately produced lasting rule, so the bare fact of invasion is not what makes the turning point. Saying no invasion reached India contradicts the whole chapter. Claiming the Arabs went deeper than the Turks reverses the actual order of penetration.

Asserting both waves left identical governments erases the very difference the chapter builds on, since only the later wave produced lasting rule.

3. (B) Resilience, as the chapter frames it, is the active creation of new work during the upheaval, not passive endurance; identical rebuilding only after the danger passed would be mere survival and recovery, not resilience, so it is the correct 'would not count' answer. New scholarship produced while invasions were under way is a textbook instance of resilience. New devotional movements arising in the same decades likewise show creative vitality under pressure. Raising fresh monumental temples amid the turmoil is exactly the productive flourishing the chapter calls resilience.

4. (D) The chapter explains repeated entry through the north-west by the long use of those mountain passes as overland trade-and-invasion routes, a geographic fact about land approaches, not a claim about missing sea defences. Saying India had no coastline is false and is contradicted by the maritime Cholas. Claiming the Cholas had no ships is overturned by the very navy and Srivijaya expedition the chapter highlights. Calling the passes Chola naval bases confuses an inland mountain corridor in the north-west with the southern sea power and is plainly wrong.

5. (C) The chapter situates the Hindu Shahis at the north-western frontier, where they attempted to hold the approaches against the earliest Turkic incursions; that defensive frontier role is why they belong to the early phase. Placing them in the Tamil south as builders of Brihadishvara confuses them with the Cholas. Crediting them with founding the Delhi Sultanate transfers to them the later work of Aibak. Sending them by sea to Srivijaya borrows the Cholas' maritime expedition and has nothing to do with a north-western land frontier.

6. (D) Since the chapter ties repeated entry to the usable passes, removing those routes would block the overland invaders and disrupt the sequence that eventually produced lasting rule. The idea that Mahmud would then rule India inverts his loot-and-leave pattern and is unsupported. The southern Cholas' navy depended on the sea, not on the northern passes, so it would be unaffected. Al-Biruni's Sanskrit study was a scholarly pursuit independent of any single mountain corridor, so blocking the passes would not erase his learning.

7. (C) The chapter defines plunder as goods taken by force in a raid, after which the raider departs, so Mahmud's wealth is fully explained without any lasting rule. Denying that Mahmud entered India contradicts his roughly seventeen documented expeditions. Insisting treasure requires years of governing is exactly the false premise the question targets, since raiding gathers wealth without governing. Linking his treasure to founding the Delhi Sultanate is wrong because that Sultanate was founded later by Aibak, a Ghurid general, not by Mahmud.

- 8. (C)** The chapter pairs Mahmud's notorious raid with Somnath and credits Brihadishvara to the Chola king Rajaraja I in the far south, a region Mahmud's northern raids did not reach. Equating Angkor Wat with Brihadishvara conflates a Cambodian temple with a Tamil one. Treating Nalanda as the same building as Brihadishvara confuses a Buddhist university in the east with a Chola Shiva temple in the south. Accepting the card as accurate ignores that the southern Chola country lay beyond Mahmud's raiding range.
- 9. (A)** The chapter draws a sharp line: a raider seizes loot and withdraws, whereas a conqueror remains to rule, so each student has attached the other's definition to the wrong word. Accepting both as correct endorses the very reversal the chapter warns against. Saying only the first is right would mean a conqueror leaves immediately, contradicting the chapter's sense of conquest as staying to govern. Claiming the terms are identical erases the loot-and-leave versus stay-to-rule contrast on which the whole argument about Mahmud and the Ghurids depends.
- 10. (D)** Shared violence does not make two forces the same kind; the chapter's decisive contrast is consequence, namely that the Ghurids stayed to rule while Mahmud always left with plunder. Saying the Ghurids never crossed the passes is false, since they reached the north and ruled there. Claiming Mahmud governed for centuries while the Ghurids only raided reverses the actual roles. Calling the Ghurids a southern dynasty that absorbed the Cholas misplaces a north-western conquering power into the free south.
- 11. (B)** The chapter measures lasting rule by whether a force remained to govern, and the Ghurids did so while Mahmud, for all his raids, always withdrew, so frequency of raiding is beside the point. Saying Mahmud reached India only once contradicts his roughly seventeen expeditions. Placing the Ghurids before Mahmud reverses the chronology, since Mahmud's raids came first. Calling Mahmud's raids peaceful trade missions denies the plundering character the chapter stresses.
- 12. (B)** The chapter's sequence runs from Mahmud's early eleventh-century raids, to the later Ghurid conquest that established lasting rule, and then to Aibak, a Ghurid general, founding the Delhi Sultanate. Putting the Ghurids before Mahmud's raids reverses the opening step. Starting with Aibak's Sultanate places the consequence before its causes. Putting Aibak's Sultanate before the Ghurids' rule inverts the order, since Aibak's foundation came out of the Ghurid conquest, not before it.
- 13. (C)** The chapter judges by outcome: the Ghurid conquest issued in lasting rule and the Delhi Sultanate, whereas Mahmud's raids ended in withdrawal with no government left. Saying both produced a sultanate erases that difference. Claiming neither left a lasting result ignores the Ghurid-founded Sultanate. Crediting Mahmud's raids with the sultanate while calling the Ghurids mere looters exactly inverts the two forces' actual records.

14. (C) The chapter assigns the founding of the Delhi Sultanate to Aibak, a general of the later Ghurid conquest, well after Mahmud's raids, so Mahmud cannot be among its founders. Saying Mahmud never reached India contradicts his many expeditions. Crediting the Hindu Shahis confuses north-western frontier defenders with the Sultanate's founders. Calling the Sultanate a southern Chola kingdom misplaces a northern, foreign-founded state into the free south.

15. (A) The chapter records Prithviraj winning the First Battle of Tarain in 1191 and losing the Second in 1192, the loss that opened the way to lasting Ghurid rule, so the pupil has swapped the outcomes. The pupil's dates are correct, so reversing them introduces a new error. Endorsing the pupil's lose-then-win version repeats the very reversal being corrected. Saying both battles were Ghurid victories wrongly denies Prithviraj's genuine win in 1191.

16. (D) The chapter makes the Second Battle the hinge because Ghuri's win there led on to lasting rule and the Delhi Sultanate, whereas the First, which Prithviraj won, only delayed him. Saying the First ended the Ghurid threat permanently is false, since Ghuri returned to win the next year. Calling the First a sea battle is wrong, as Tarain was a land engagement. Claiming the Second restored the Hindu Shahis confuses a much earlier frontier power with the Ghurid victory.

17. (D) Reversing the battles would make 1191 a defeat and 1192 a victory for Prithviraj, masking the true path in which his early win was followed by the decisive loss that opened the door to Ghurid rule. Putting Mahmud at Tarain is wrong, since the battles were fought by Muhammad Ghuri, not Mahmud. Crediting the Cholas with deciding them imports a southern sea power into a northern land war. Dating the battles before the Arab arrival in Sindh inverts the chapter's chronology entirely.

18. (D) The chapter sets Aibak's founding of the Sultanate beside Bakhtiyar Khilji's destruction of the universities to show construction of new rule alongside destruction of old learning, the two faces of conquest. Saying both stayed unchanged contradicts both the new Sultanate and the lost universities. Reducing the pair to mere raiding ignores that Aibak's work was governing, not looting. Linking them to the Cholas' navy misplaces a northern conquest into the southern sea power's story.

19. (C) The chapter assigns the ruin of the eastern Buddhist universities to Bakhtiyar Khilji during the later Ghurid conquest, not to Mahmud's earlier raids. Naming Rajaraja Chola I confuses a southern temple-builder with the destroyer. Naming al-Biruni inverts his role, since he studied and recorded Indian knowledge rather than destroying it. Naming the Hindu Shahis confuses north-western frontier defenders with the agent of the universities' destruction.

20. (D) The chapter values Nalanda and Vikramashila as great Buddhist universities, so their destruction harmed learning at its source, beyond the loss of any single settlement.

Calling them Chola naval bases confuses centres of study with southern military installations. Labelling them Turkic frontier forts turns places of learning into the invaders' own outposts. Naming them Tamil trading ports recasts universities as commercial harbours, missing why their loss struck at knowledge.

21. (B) The chapter answers the propaganda charge by pointing to al-Biruni's mastery of Sanskrit and his careful, serious account of Indian sciences, religion and customs, the mark of genuine scholarship rather than propaganda. Saying he wrote nothing denies the very book the chapter praises. Saying he refused to study India contradicts his deep engagement with Sanskrit learning. Casting him as the destroyer of the universities confuses the recording scholar with the general Bakhtiyar Khilji.

22. (C) Two-way learning needs flow in both directions, and the chapter supplies it: a foreign scholar studying India inward, and Indian sine tables moving outward. The destroying-and-copying option describes loss and one-sided imitation, not mutual exchange. The all-receiving option captures only one direction. The no-exchange option denies any flow at all, which contradicts both named facts.

23. (B) The export of Indian sine tables is precisely evidence that India contributed knowledge outward, making it a giver as well as a receiver, the reverse of the student's claim. Saying India had no mathematics is contradicted by those very sine tables. Saying India only borrowed repeats the error the export refutes. Saying its knowledge never left its borders is disproved by the tables travelling outward.

24. (B) The chapter glosses al-jabr as 'reunion of broken parts', the source of the word algebra, and a vimana as the shrine tower of a South Indian temple, so the worksheet has muddled both. Making al-jabr a temple tower and vimana algebra simply swaps the errors. Tying both terms to the cosmic mountain confuses them with Mount Meru. Calling al-jabr a Kannada poem and vimana a fleet of ships mislabels both, borrowing meanings that belong to vachana and navy.

25. (C) The chapter ties trigonometry to astronomy because it deals with triangles and angles, the tools for fixing positions in the sky. Linking it to temple gateways confuses mathematics with the torana. Linking it to warships confuses it with the navy. Linking it to Kannada poems confuses it with the vachana, none of which is the geometry of angles astronomers needed.

26. (B) An Arabic-rooted term and an Indian export side by side show ideas and names moving across cultures, the picture of an international mathematics. Saying it was invented solely in India ignores the Arabic al-jabr. Crediting Turkic generals confuses soldiers with mathematicians. Saying mathematics was abandoned is contradicted by both the named subject and the active export of sine tables.

27. (B) A foreign scholar studying India and an Indian mathematician advancing his subject during the invasions together show scholarship continuing, refuting the idea that invasion ended serious learning. Refuting that India never had mathematics needs only one of the two, not the pairing's point about continuity. The southern kingdoms' freedom is a separate, geographic claim untouched by these two scholars. The Cholas' navy is likewise a separate maritime fact, not what the pairing addresses.

28. (D) A great mathematician-astronomer working in these decades shows Indian science continuing to advance even as the north was raided, the chapter's point about endurance. Calling Indian science a foreign invention is contradicted by an Indian doing the work. Saying mathematics vanished until the Cholas revived it is disproved by Bhaskaracharya's own active career. Confining science to Mahmud's raided regions ignores that learning thrived across India, including the free south.

29. (C) The chapter defines a torana as a decorative stone gateway, the kind of monumental art the Kakatiyas built at Warangal. The tall shrine tower is a vimana, not a torana. A village assembly is a governing body, not a gateway. A subordinate ruler is a person, not a piece of architecture, so all three distractors mislabel the term.

30. (C) The chapter groups the three as flourishing southern and Deccan powers that thrived while the north was under attack, evidence that not all India fell. Calling them Turkic dynasties of the passes turns free Indian kingdoms into invaders. Making them founders of the Delhi Sultanate confuses them with Aibak's northern state. Calling them Mahmud's Central Asian allies again recasts independent southern powers as the invading force.

31. (A) Two thriving Deccan powers building and ruling during the invasions show the south staying free and creative, the chapter's central counterweight to the northern raids. Saying all India had fallen is contradicted by these very kingdoms. Saying the Deccan was ruled from Ghazni places a free region under the invaders. Saying the south had no kingdoms is disproved by the named Kakatiyas and Hoysalas.

32. (D) The label scholar-king highlights that Bhoja combined governing with a genuine devotion to learning. Saying he never ruled denies the kingly half of the title. Calling him a foreign invader misplaces an Indian ruler among the Turks. Putting him in command of the Chola navy confuses a northern Paramara king with the southern sea power.

33. (A) The chapter links the two Cholas as rulers who built up Chola strength, including naval power, and widened the dynasty's reach. Raiding Somnath belongs to Mahmud, not the Cholas. Defeat at Tarain belongs to Prithviraj Chauhan in the north. Founding Buddhist universities describes Nalanda's institutional history, not the work of these southern kings.

34. (A) The Srivijaya expedition shows the Cholas projecting power across the ocean, marking the south as a strong sea power while the north was raided. Calling the south landlocked contradicts a naval expedition. Making it a Ghurid vassal subordinates a free, far-reaching power to the northern invaders. Saying it knew nothing beyond its coast is refuted by a fleet sailing to Southeast Asia.

35. (A) Putting a southern sea power beside northern overland raids pictures India as divided between a flourishing maritime south and a repeatedly raided north. Saying power was wholly in Ghazni ignores the free southern kingdoms. Calling it wholly maritime erases the land kingdoms of the north and Deccan. Confining power to the Hindu Shahis reduces a broad picture to a single frontier dynasty.

36. (B) The chapter uses navy for a country's warships and their crews and vimana for the shrine tower of a South Indian temple. Swapping the two, so that navy is the tower and vimana the fleet, simply reverses the definitions. Calling both a decorative gateway confuses them with the torana. Calling a navy a Kannada poem and a vimana a village assembly borrows meanings belonging to vachana and to a sabha, not to these terms.

37. (A) A towering Chola temple built in these decades shows grand temple architecture thriving in the free south while the north was raided. Saying the Cholas built only after the Sultanate fell misorders events, since the Brihadishvara belongs to this very period. Claiming Mahmud sponsored Chola temples links a northern raider to southern building he had nothing to do with. Saying the south abandoned temple construction is flatly contradicted by the temple itself.

38. (A) The chapter presents Vishishtadvaita as holding that the world and souls are real, with devotion and surrender to God as the road to liberation. Calling the world wholly unreal states a different philosophical position the chapter does not assign to Ramanuja. Saying ritual sacrifice alone frees the soul is the very ritualism his bhakti path moves beyond. Denying any gods contradicts a teaching centred on surrender to God.

39. (C) The chapter names the Anubhava mandapa as the hall where Basavanna welcomed people of all backgrounds to share ideas, embodying the movement's openness. The Delhi Sultanate is a state founded by Aibak, not a hall of discussion. A torana is a gateway, not an institution of debate. The Chola navy is a military fleet, unrelated to Basavanna's gathering.

40. (A) The chapter defines a vachana as a short Kannada poem carrying spiritual and ethical teaching, Basavanna's chosen medium. The shrine tower is a vimana, not a poem. A fleet of fighting ships is a navy. A decorative gateway is a torana, so each distractor swaps a piece of architecture or a fleet for a poetic form.

41. (B) Opening the hall to everyone and rejecting caste expresses a commitment to equality and open exchange across social backgrounds. Valuing strict caste hierarchy is the

opposite of what the movement did. Prizing a sultan's supremacy belongs to the political world of conquest, not to Basavanna's reform. Aiming at military conquest of the south confuses a devotional movement with warfare.

42. (B) Two major new devotional currents arising in these decades show the age generating fresh religious thought even as invasions pressed, the chapter's point. Saying it produced no religious thought is contradicted by both movements. Calling it only war ignores this spiritual flowering. Saying foreign rule replaced all spiritual life is disproved by thinkers active in the free south and beyond.

43. (D) Two great temples in different regions show India rich in temple art across the land during the period. Saying there was no building contradicts the monuments themselves. Saying every region was ruled from Ghazni denies the free regions that produced these temples. Saying India was stripped of artistic activity is refuted by the very art being cited.

44. (C) A Cambodian temple echoing the Indian idea of Mount Meru shows Indian cultural and religious ideas radiating peacefully far abroad. Saying India conquered Cambodia turns cultural reach into military rule the chapter does not claim. Saying Cambodia ruled India reverses the direction of influence. Saying India had no temples is contradicted by Brihadishvara and Khajuraho at home.

45. (D) The chapter identifies Mount Meru as the cosmic mountain at the centre of the universe in Indian cosmology, mirrored by Angkor Wat's towers. Calling it a fortress of Mahmud confuses a cosmological symbol with a raider's stronghold. Calling it a Chola warship confuses it with the navy. Calling it a Buddhist university confuses it with Nalanda.

46. (B) Great temples at home plus an Indian-influenced temple abroad show a thriving cultural centre whose ideas reached well beyond its borders. Calling it barren and isolated is contradicted by both the home temples and the foreign echo. Saying invaders ruled every region denies the free south that built these works. Saying temple-building was forbidden is disproved by the temples themselves.

47. (C) The chapter uses vimana for the shrine tower and torana for the decorative gateway. Swapping them, so vimana is the gateway and torana the tower, reverses the definitions. Calling both warships confuses architecture with the navy. Calling a vimana a Kannada poem and a torana a sultan's realm borrows meanings that belong to vachana and to a sultanate.

48. (D) The Cholas, Kakatiyas and Hoysalas are the free southern and Deccan powers the chapter celebrates, so the Ghurids, a north-western conquering force, are the odd one out. The Cholas belong with the free south as its great sea power. The Kakatiyas belong there as

the Deccan builders of the Warangal torana. The Hoysalas belong there as another flourishing Deccan dynasty.

49. (A) The chapter pairs Mahmud with plundering raids, Ghuri with staying to rule, and Aibak with founding the Delhi Sultanate. The option giving Mahmud the Sultanate, Ghuri mere raiding, and Aibak a voyage to Srivijaya scrambles all three roles. The option ruling the south, building Angkor Wat, and writing on algebra assigns inventions and works none of them did. The option of the Chola navy, destroying Nalanda, and defending the Khyber misassigns deeds belonging to the Cholas, Bakhtiyar Khilji and the frontier defenders.

50. (D) The chapter rebuts the only-ruin view by listing the scholars, thinker-saints and temples that flourished in the very same decades. Denying that any invasions occurred is false and unnecessary, since the point is what coexisted with them. Claiming the south was also ruined surrenders the very evidence of survival. Saying all learning ceased until the next century contradicts al-Biruni and Bhaskaracharya working within the period.

51. (A) The title captures a genuine turn: invasion shifting from raids to lasting northern rule, while the free south and a thriving culture continued, the chapter's balanced summary. Saying the whole subcontinent fell and culture died ignores the free south and the period's flowering. Saying nothing changed denies the very shift the title names. Saying India conquered its north-western and overseas neighbours reverses the direction of conquest the chapter records.

52. (C) The chapter's chain runs from the passes that allowed repeated entry, to the decisive Ghurid win at the Second Tarain in 1192, to Aibak's founding of the Delhi Sultanate, a clean cause-to-effect sequence. The first distractor wrongly makes Mahmud's raids found the Sultanate and puts the passes last. The second links a southern naval expedition to a northern conquest and has the Ghurids losing yet ruling, which is incoherent. The third turns a scholar's study into a military guide and credits the First Tarain, which Ghuri lost, with founding the Sultanate.

53. (B) One caption is a scholar preserving Indian knowledge and the other a general destroying a centre of learning, so foreign contact cut both ways depending on the figure's role. Calling it uniformly destructive ignores al-Biruni's preservation. Calling it uniformly preserving ignores Bakhtiyar Khilji's destruction. Saying it had no effect denies both the recorded astronomy and the ruined university.

54. (D) The chapter holds both truths at once: the south stayed free and flourished, yet the north really was raided, so claiming no part of India was touched goes too far. Saying the Cholas were raided denies the free south the chapter affirms. Saying the north was never raided contradicts the chapter's account of the Turkic invasions. Saying only the south was touched reverses which region actually faced the raids.

55. (A) The chapter makes the loot-versus-govern distinction carry real weight: it marks Mahmud's leave-after-raiding from the Ghurids' stay-to-rule, which is exactly when lasting foreign rule began. Calling it mere vocabulary denies its role in dating that rule. Saying frequent raiding means longest governing confuses raiding with ruling, the very error the distinction guards against. Saying conquest leaves less than a raid inverts the truth, since it was conquest, not raiding, that left a lasting government.

56. (D) The vimana, the torana and Angkor Wat's towers are all monumental works of a free or culturally radiating India, while Mahmud's looted treasure represents plunder taken away, the opposite of creative monumental art, so it does not belong. The Brihadishvara vimana is exactly such southern temple art. The Warangal torana is Deccan monumental art of a free kingdom. Angkor Wat's Meru towers show Indian ideas radiating abroad, all three fitting the group the loot does not.

57. (A) The two facts support distinct conclusions: al-Biruni's careful book attests to continuing scholarship despite invasion, whereas the Srivijaya expedition attests to the free south's sea power, so they are not interchangeable. Saying both show the south was conquered contradicts a flourishing, sea-faring Chola state. Saying both show learning stopped is refuted by al-Biruni's very study. Saying both show India ruled Cambodia and Srivijaya confuses cultural reach and a single expedition with permanent conquest.

58. (C) Each claim fails the chapter's test: Mahmud raided and left rather than ruling, much of India, including the whole south, stayed free, and the age produced al-Biruni, Bhaskaracharya, Ramanuja, Basava and great temples, so none is correct. Saying all three are correct accepts every error at once. Saying only the first is wrong still wrongly grants that the subcontinent fell and that nothing was created. Saying only the third is wrong still wrongly grants Mahmud's rule over all India.

59. (A) The chapter's whole point is that learning flowed both ways: a foreign scholar recording Indian knowledge inward and Indian sine tables travelling outward, so the two examples move in opposite directions and cannot be one-way. Saying both show India only receiving ignores that the sine tables were an Indian export. Saying both show foreigners only taking ignores that al-Biruni's book carried Indian knowledge to others. Calling them military matters confuses scholarship and mathematics with warfare.

60. (B) The chapter juxtaposes the raids with Chola sea power, Deccan monumental art and Basava's hall of debate precisely to show creation flourishing alongside invasion, so the age was far more than war. Crediting these to the Turkic invaders turns free Indian achievements into the invaders' work. Saying they came only after the invasions ended misdates works that belong to the same period as the raids. Saying all three were destroyed to prove only ruin contradicts the chapter's use of them as living evidence of flourishing.